



COMMUTERS zip past a billboard blasting President Trump that's been erected in Tehran's Valiasr Square. AFP/Getty Images

Attacks in gulf renew fears of long war

Iran strikes UAE and Oman, undermining confidence in strength of ceasefire with U.S.

By NABIH BULOS AND MICHAEL WILNER

BEIRUT — Confusion reigned on Monday over the fate of a fragile ceasefire between the United States and Iran after a wave of fresh strikes on the United Arab Emirates and Oman, along with reports of attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz, undermined confidence in the truce.

The drone and missile strikes, the first since a ceasefire halted fighting in early April, come after the Trump administration launched a wide-scale naval operation on Monday to “guide” stranded maritime vessels out of the vital waterway.

But fears over a return to war have driven another surge in oil prices, pushing them above \$114 per barrel — levels not seen since the ceasefire nearly a month ago. Hundreds of cargo ships from dozens of countries remain stuck in the gulf. And strikes in Dubai have raised concerns about further disruptions to international air travel at one of the world's busiest airports.

Iran's state-run news agency, IRNA, said the new U.S. operation was part of President Trump's “delirium,” after the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps warned that passage through the strait required prior approval from Tehran.

“We warn that any foreign armed force, especially the invading American army, will be attacked if they attempt to approach and enter the Strait of Hormuz,” said Maj. Gen. Ali Abdollahi, according to a statement reported by the Iranian state-run Mehr News Agency on Monday.

The operation, which Trump over the weekend dubbed Project Freedom, is supported by 15,000 U.S. service members and 100 aircraft, according to U.S. Central Command. Their aim is to deny Tehran control over the strait, a narrow, 21-mile-wide passageway through which a fifth of global energy supplies flows.

On Monday, Trump vowed Iran's forces will be “blown off the face of the Earth” if they attempt to disrupt Project Freedom.

“We have more weapons and ammunition at a much higher grade than we had before,” Trump was quoted as saying in an interview [See Iran, A3]

BIG-NAME DONORS IN MAYORAL RACE

Celebrities are among those contributing to L.A. candidates ahead of the June 2 primary

By Noah Goldberg

The roster of campaign contributors to Los Angeles mayoral candidates has something in common with the court-side seats at Lakers games: Both are sprinkled with the rich and famous.

There's Colin Jost, “Saturday Night Live's” Weekend Update host, popping up as a donor to Councilmember Nithya Raman. Mayor Karen Bass, meanwhile, counts former Major League Baseball star Dave Winfield among her contributors.

Lakers governor and part-owner Jeanie Buss is there too, as a donor to reality TV personality Spencer Pratt. All three gave the maximum \$1,800 contribu-

tions to their chosen candidates.

With Los Angeles at the center of the entertainment industry, big names like Jost, Winfield and Buss (none of whom responded to requests for comment) are par for the course in local elections. There might have been even more celebrity contributions were it not for the late-breaking entries of Pratt and Raman in the race, said political consultant Mike Trujillo.

“It's a very short timeline that is not usual for a mayor's race where you're challenging an incumbent,” said Trujillo, who isn't affiliated with any of the may- [See Mayor, A7]

DEBATES: Two candidate forums are planned this week. CALIFORNIA, B1

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court often resembles a feuding family where the same heated arguments go on for years.

The justices disagree over race, religion, abortion, guns and the environment, and more recently, presidential power and LGBTQ+ rights. And while they try to maintain a cordial working relationship, they don't claim to be good friends.

“We are stuck with one another whether we like it or not,” Justice Amy Barrett wrote last year in her book “Listening to the Law.”

And like it or not, the testy exchanges and simmering anger have been increasing, driven by the sharp ideological divide.

The three liberals had known since October the conservative majority was preparing to elevate partisan power over racial fairness.

By retreating from part of the Voting Rights Act, the court's opinion last week by Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. will allow Republicans across the South to dismantle voting districts that favor Black Democrats.

Justice Elena Kagan, who first came to the court as a [See Court, A6]

Simmering anger fills Supreme Court

As conservative justices move law further to the right, tension grows

By David G. Savage



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON Associated Press

CHIEF JUSTICE John G. Roberts Jr. arrives at the U.S. Capitol alongside Justice Elena Kagan in 2025.

ABORTION PILLS: Supreme Court restores access by mail for now as justices take up the case. NATION, A6

California may suspend and fine State Farm

Agency accuses home insurer of hundreds of violations in handling 2025 wildfire claims.

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

California regulators may seek to suspend State Farm's license for up to a year and levy millions in penalties against the insurer, alleging it mishandled January 2025 wildfire claims in Los Angeles County.

In an extraordinary step, the Department of Insurance announced Monday that it filed an administrative action against the state's largest home insurer after an investigation into 220 sample claims found 398 violations of state law in about half of them.

“Our investigation found that State Farm delayed, underpaid, and buried policyholders in red tape at the worst moment of their lives,” Insurance Commissioner Ricardo Lara said in a statement. “That is unacceptable, and we are taking decisive action to hold them accountable.”

The department is seeking a cease-and-desist order to stop the insurer from engaging in unfair or deceptive practices — and to possibly suspend State Farm's “certificate of authority” for up to a year, meaning it could not write policies during that period, department spokesperson Michael Soller said.

While the terms of the proposed suspension aren't clear, the move could prevent the insurer — which covers more than 1 million homes — from issuing new policies at a time when the state is facing an insurance crisis.

The case will be heard by a state administrative law judge, who will provide a recommendation to Lara on a possible monetary penalty and whether to carry out the license suspension. State regulators declined to comment on the action or how it might affect policyholders.

State Farm on Monday rejected the department's claims that it engaged in a “general practice of mishandling or intentionally underpaying wildfire claims” and said it will further respond through the legal process. [See Insurance, A11]

A motive alleged in Palisades fire

Suspect's own words and other evidence show he resented the rich, prosecutors say.

By RICHARD WINTON

The man accused of starting the Palisades fire, one of the costliest disasters in U.S. history, was motivated by a resentment for the rich and viewed Luigi Mangione, the suspect in the killing of UnitedHealthcare's chief executive, as a Robin Hood-like figure, according to court documents detailing evidence gathered by federal prosecutors.

In a court brief filed last week, authorities say a forensic review of his computer showed Jonathan Rinderknecht searched “Free Luigi” and “reddit lets kill all billionaires” in December 2024.

Rinderknecht, 30, is accused of starting the Lachman fire in Pacific Palisades on Jan. 1, 2025, which smoldered underground for a week before exploding into

the deadly Palisades fire.

According to the brief, passengers described Rinderknecht — who worked as an Uber driver — as “angry, intense, driving erratically and ranting about being ‘pissed off at the world’ and Luigi Mangione, capitalism and vigilantism,” in the hours before the clock struck midnight.

“On New Year's Eve 2024, the defendant was alone again,” federal prosecutors wrote in the 25-page brief. They allege that a relationship with a co-worker had ended that year and that she rebuffed him again on Dec. 30, leading to a “visceral reaction: He left her two manic voicemails and entered prompts into ChatGPT expressing his extreme displeasure with her treatment of him.”

Authorities allege in their brief that he was stewing over being in the neighborhood of his ex-lover and listening to a French rap song that evoked images of fire in its music video.

It may be too much of a stretch to tie all these pieces [See Palisades, A7]

A luxury Antarctic cruise turns deadly

By RONG-GONG LIN II

Hantavirus is suspected of spreading aboard a luxury cruise ship, killing three passengers and sparking new concerns as a once obscure disease, with an extraordinarily high death rate, rises amid changing climate conditions.

Officials are still trying to determine what happened aboard the ship, which commands fares of up to \$28,845 for a 46-day journey that includes a tour of the Antarctica Peninsula and stops in Tierra del Fuego on the southern edge of Argentina.

In addition to the three deaths, a fourth passenger was evacuated to a South African hospital and is in intensive care, and two crew members are ill. The Dutch-flagged ship remains off the coast of Cape Verde, the island nation about 400 miles west of Senegal, where it was scheduled to have docked

Monday.

Among the possibilities that could explain the suspected outbreak, Dr. Peter Chin-Hong, a UC San Francisco infectious-diseases expert said, are rodents getting on board the ship and exposing people to the virus, or person-to-person transmission.

“Could a cruise member have been cleaning up an area and incidentally aerosolized some rodent droppings?” said Dr. Elizabeth Hudson, regional chief of infectious diseases at Kaiser Permanente Southern California. “Was there a shore excursion that the passengers and crew attended where they were exposed to aerosolized rodent droppings?”

Because hantavirus is so rare, it's hard to say what effect these deaths might have on the cruise industry. COVID-19 hit the industry hard, but that was a global pandemic with a virus [See Ship, A7]



GINA FERRAZZI Los Angeles Times

SPOKE TALES

Mechanic Olin Reyes toils in a dusty basement to salvage bicycles left behind by patients at the closed General Hospital in L.A. CALIFORNIA, B1

Mega-mansion in Bel-Air for sale

The \$400-million estate owned by Qatar's royal family would be the most expensive in U.S. history. BUSINESS, A9

Lakers' hopes center on Ayton

Big man's strong play will be paramount as they take on the defending champion Thunder. SPORTS, B10

Weather

A shower in spots. L.A. Basin: 68/54. B6



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